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Reading Comprehension: Main Idea

Students identify the central message in a paragraph and support it with evidence.

- A main idea sentence tells what most of the paragraph is about.
- Supporting details explain, prove, or describe the main idea.
- Readers should ask: What point is the writer trying to make?
- Practice with short passages improves confidence and speed.

Practice prompts:

- * What is one key idea from this page?
- * Write one sentence using a term from this page.
- * How could this skill support better classroom communication?

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Vocabulary in Context

Context clues help readers infer the meaning of unfamiliar words.

- Definition clues give direct explanations near the unknown word.
- Synonym clues provide similar words in the same sentence.
- Antonym clues show contrast with signal words like however or unlike.
- Example clues list items that reveal the meaning.

Practice prompts:

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Narrative Writing Structure

A clear narrative includes a beginning, middle, and end with purposeful events.

- The beginning introduces characters, setting, and problem.
- The middle develops conflict through actions and dialogue.
- The ending resolves the problem and shows change.
- Strong transitions maintain the flow of events.

Practice prompts:

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Grammar Focus: Subject-Verb Agreement

Subjects and verbs must match in number and person.

- Singular subjects take singular verbs: The student writes.
- Plural subjects take plural verbs: The students write.
- Prepositional phrases do not change the subject.
- Collective nouns may be singular in formal academic English.

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Poetry Devices

Poets use language techniques to create sound, image, and emotion.

- Alliteration repeats initial consonant sounds.
- Metaphor compares two ideas without using like or as.
- Imagery appeals to the five senses.
- Rhythm and rhyme shape how a poem is read aloud.

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Informational Text Features

Headings, captions, diagrams, and glossaries support understanding.

- Headings organize sections by topic.
- Captions explain images and graphs.
- Glossaries define technical terms.
- Indexes help locate specific ideas quickly.

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Argumentative Writing Basics

An argument states a claim, gives reasons, and supports each reason with evidence.

- A claim is the writer's position on an issue.
- Reasons explain why the claim should be accepted.
- Evidence can include facts, statistics, or expert statements.
- A counterargument acknowledges a different view respectfully.

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Listening and Speaking Skills

Academic discussion requires active listening and clear spoken responses.

- Listen for key points before responding.
- Use sentence starters to build respectful discussion.
- Paraphrase another speaker to confirm understanding.
- Support spoken opinions with examples.

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Editing and Revision

Revision improves ideas; editing improves correctness.

- During revision, add detail and improve organization.
- During editing, correct spelling, punctuation, and grammar.
- Reading aloud helps identify awkward phrasing.
- Peer feedback can highlight unclear sections.

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Assessment Practice

Students combine reading, writing, grammar, and vocabulary skills in one task.

- Read a short text and identify the author's purpose.
- Answer vocabulary-in-context questions.
- Write a paragraph with a clear topic sentence and evidence.
- Check final work using a simple editing checklist.

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